

# Simplest: Bag-of-Words trick

- Most search engines use BOW
  - treat documents and queries as bags of words
- A “bag” is a set with repetitions
  - match = “degree of overlap” between  $d$ ,  $q$
- Retrieval models
  - statistical models (functions): usually use words as features
  - decide which documents most likely to be relevant
- BOW makes these models tractable (and also effective!)